1.1 Problem Statement

The international graduates are major contributors to the economy of New Zealand in terms of labor force, cultural diversity, and workforce elasticity. Nevertheless, their successful inclusion into the labor market is not guaranteed either, with a range of problems potentially experienced by the migrants, including their lack of local work experience, difficulty in adjusting to the cultural expectations, and unfamiliarity with the expectations at the workplace. Perceived organizational support can be viewed as the extent to which an employee feels that the organization cares about their well-being and values their contributions (Chance, 2023).

Employment success as the key outcome variable is conceptualized in terms of two levels, namely intrinsically and extrinsically. The literature previously postulated a positive relationship between perceived organization support and employment success measures, although most studies have not been conducted in the New Zealand context, and definitely not in the case of international graduates (Staffhouse International Resources, 2025).

It is specifically the relevance of organizational support that may be particularly relevant in the context of situations when international graduates are supposed to begin their work, and hence, it may be particularly high because of the pressures of professional integration, work flexibility, and career mobility (Mohammad et al., 2025). However, it is still not clear whether there are similar relationship patterns between perceived organizational support and employment success of international graduates in New Zealand in their different career paths and industries.

1.2 Research Objectives

The proposed study will seek to establish the degree to which perceived organizational support affects the employment success of international graduates in New Zealand. Specifically, it attempts:

1. To evaluate the degree of perceived organizational support among international graduates in New Zealand, with respect to:
    a. Recognition of employee contributions;
    b. Support from supervisors;
    c. Quality of job conditions; and
    d. Fair treatment and equitable workplace policies.
2. To evaluate the perceived level of employment success among international

graduates with respect to:

a. Intrinsic outcomes; and
b. Extrinsic outcomes

3. To establish the difference between the actual perceived organizational support and the intrinsic nature of employment success.
4. To test whether there is a statistically significant difference between perceived organizational support and extrinsic aspects of employment success.
5. To examine the correlation between perceived organizational support and overall employment success among New Zealand international graduates.

Hypothesis

The hypothesis to be tested at the 0.05 level includes:

H_0: There is no statistical association between perceived organizational support and the employment outcomes of international graduates in New Zealand.

H_1: There is a significant relationship between perceived organizational support and the employment success of international graduates in New Zealand.

1.3 Research Questions

A central research problem in this context is to establish the extent to which perceived organizational support has an effect on the employment success of international graduates in New Zealand. This study will primarily focus on the following questions:

This study will primarily focus on the following questions:

1. What is the level of perceived organizational support experienced by international graduates in New Zealand in terms of:

   a. Recognition of employee contributions;
   b. Support from supervisors;
   c. Quality of job conditions; and
   d. Fair treatment and equitable workplace policies?

2. What is the perceived level of employment success among these graduates in relation to:

   a. Intrinsic outcomes; and
   b. Extrinsic outcomes?

3. Is there a significant difference between perceived organizational support and intrinsic aspects of employment success?
4. Is there a significant difference between perceived organizational support and extrinsic aspects of employment success?

5. Is there a significant relationship between perceived organizational support and employment success among international graduates in New Zealand?

Chapter III: Research Methodology

This section presents the methodological processes that will be used to explore the connection between the perceived organizational support and the employment success of the international graduates in New Zealand. The identified strategies of data collection and analysis techniques will help to make sure that the findings will have an empirical basis and will be relevant in terms of the population being explored.

2. Research Philosophy

The study conforms to a positivist research philosophy, which emphasizes objectivity, measurement, and empirical evidence to establish facts. Positivism is based on the assumption that reality is constant and can be observed and described in an objective position without any interference of the researcher (Prime, 2024). This philosophical stand is appropriate in the context of the current study, as it examines the international organizational programs and conditions of working with the help of quantifiable variables and observable patterns of foreign people, students, and professionals. The principles governing positivism emphasize the production of credible and valid information that can result in the establishment of generalizable conclusions and objective facts concerning the investigated phenomena. This will ensure that the results can be used to inform decision-making processes among study beneficiaries.

The positivist methodology allows the researcher to ensure that methodological rigor and neutrality are maintained during the research process through the use of structured measurement, including standardized surveys and quantitative analysis. This philosophy assumes that social phenomena would be studied using the same scientific techniques as in the natural sciences, where causal relationships would have been established using systematic observation and analysis. This focus on quantifiable evidence and absence of subjective interpretation ought to provide the study with the potential to produce results that are replicable, provable, and not dependent on any personal assumptions. This would contribute to the credibility and the trustworthiness of the findings and ensure that it will result in a more empirical understanding of the role played by international relations and organizational practices in the assimilation issues and the performance levels of foreign students and professionals in multicultural and global workplaces.

2.1 Methodological Choice

The study will be designed to follow a quantitative mono-method approach, whereby only numerical data will be used in responding to the research questions (EBSCO Information Services, 2025). The security of the single quantitative approach improves the reliability and validity of the study, as the structure minimizes the researcher's bias and ensures replicability for future research. Quantitative designs are particularly applicable to studies involving large populations of people when the researcher finds it convenient to measure data, and they are also effective in a manner that can be generalized (Slater & Hasson, 2024).

2.2 Research Strategy

The research design will employ a survey strategy using a structured self-administered questionnaire. Surveys will be particularly effective for the purposes of this research, as they allow the standardized information to be gathered from a relatively large number of respondents within a limited period of time. (Salama et al., 2020). Structured questionnaires are consistent and minimize researcher bias and provide data capable of being tested statistically. The use of this survey design also involves the views of the respondents in the same conditions across the entirety of New Zealand and thus adds to the validity and reliability of the research results.

Selecting this survey strategy was considered reasonable and appropriate for reaching respondents. To ensure completeness of responses during the data collection period, the survey will be administered both online and in person to accommodate respondents' availability and preferences. Both strategies will be effective and efficient in ensuring the full participation of the targeted respondents. Through this process, the study will generate strong evidence that contributes to both theoretical and practical advances in understanding international students' employment experiences.

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2.3 Time Horizon and Time Scale

This study will be conducted in a prospective time frame. Quantitative methods through a structured survey questionnaire will be used to collect data within the span of three to four months as prescribed by the research. The prospective time frame will allow the research to concentrate on the current state of international postgraduate students working part-time in

New Zealand as well as analyze their organizational expectations and anticipated employment success rates. Rather than offering a snapshot of current conditions, the prospective design will focus on how current organizational practices are likely to shape their future employment and career paths. By combining both cross-sectional and forward-looking insights, the study will generate both descriptive and predictive knowledge that will allow refining the contribution of the findings to theory and practice.

The approach will enable respondents to report on their current circumstances using the survey format, and the analysis will project how those circumstances are likely to influence respondents' immediate employment outcomes. It will be especially valuable to organizations and policymakers by identifying the implications of current support mechanisms for future student employability.

The research will be carried out in the course of four months to meet all requirements in order to complete the final manuscript. Each month will be tied to a certain timeline according to the needs of each research stage. The preparation phase in the first month will involve completing the research design, constructing the data-gathering instrument, and obtaining validation from the experts to ensure that it corresponds to the objectives of the study. The second month will involve the distribution and administration of the questionnaire to the selected respondents. To maximize responses and motivate participation, emails or social media will be used to send the reminders, and the respondents will be provided with a sufficient amount of time to complete the survey. The third month will be used to preprocess the data generated, i.e., cleaning, coding, and data preparation to implement statistical procedures. Jamovi software will be utilized to perform descriptive analysis and inferential analysis to examine the relationship between variables. The fourth month will be devoted to finalizing the concluding sections of the research paper. This will be a prelude to the completion of the manuscript, after all prior considerations and requirements have been fulfilled. The planned sequencing of activities allows the entire process to be carried out effectively within the estimated timeframe while ensuring high quality of the output.

2.4 Gantt Chart

Task / Activity	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26
Planning & Preparation					
Research Proposal					

Proposal Finalization & Approval					
Writing Chapters 1-3					
Editing, Formatting & Proofreading (Chapter 1–3)					
Instrument Development & Validation					
Data Gathering via Survey					
Instrument Validation and Reliability Testing via Jamovi software					
Data Analysis					
Writing Chapters 4-5					
Editing, Formatting & Proofreading (Chapter 4–5)					
Bookbinding & Final Submission					

2.5 Type of Data

Two types of data will be used in this study, which includes the primary data and secondary data. This combination of two will enable this research to capture the firsthand experiences of the respondents as well as the broader contextual information needed to analyze and validate the findings.

In this study, primary information will be generated by use of surveys, which will be administered to selected part-time postgraduate international students in New Zealand. This information will be gathered using a self-developed structured questionnaire based on a 5-point Likert scale to assess students' perception of organizational support and job outcomes. The tool will assess the four dimensions of organizational support, namely recognition of contributions, supervision, working conditions, and equity of organizational policies. It will also measure two categories of employment success, namely intrinsic results related to satisfaction with the job, professional growth, and individual development, and extrinsic results associated with career progression, employability, and material compensation. Firsthand accounts of participants who are already juggling academic tasks and workplace integration will provide tangible and objective evidence required to respond to the research questions. These data will also reflect the idiosyncratic realities of target respondents, providing both relevance and authenticity to the complexities of their experience at work.

The secondary data will be obtained through the relevant and authoritative sources and data on the labor market, workplace practices, and challenges of the workforce in the analogous

environment. These data will guide the conceptual framework of the study, design the items to be included in the surveys, and interpret the results by placing them within the context of the current theory and empirical data. The use of secondary sources with primary data guarantees validity and offers in-depth information about the perspectives of the respondents and generalizes the views of the existing literature. This complementary use of data enhances the rigor and applicability of the research results.

2.6 Data Collection and Analysis

2.6.1 Population

The potential population of this research will be focused on selected international students in New Zealand, especially those taking part-time jobs and pursuing master's degree programs in New Zealand. Postgraduate learners are more career-focused, more demanding in terms of professional development, and have a greater need to advance in their future career paths. Their own privileged status allows them to simultaneously be critical about the organizational support they receive from their employers and also motivated to pursue a higher-level career trajectory.

Several inclusion criteria have been established to ensure that the participants will be relevant to the purpose of the study and be able to obtain meaningful and valid information from the targets. First, the sample of respondents will be drawn from only those respondents who are currently enrolled in a New Zealand postgraduate degree program recognized by the New Zealand Postgraduate Association. Second, they must have legal working rights under the New Zealand immigration law, which determines whether or not they are legally allowed to work in the domestic job market. Third, they work on a part-time basis regardless of the industry they work in jobs that are relative to their academic expertise. Lastly, as part of the ethical conduct of research, they shall give their consent to take part in the research and sign an informed consent form voluntarily and willingly. These requirements will ensure that all respondents are working in both academic and professional sectors simultaneously, thus enabling the capture of contemporaneous insights into the role of perceived organizational support in their work experience and career aspirations of the respondents.

In order to ensure that the research will be on track and will not compromise the integrity of the collected data, certain exclusion criteria have also been set. The sample will be restricted to those who are not currently enrolled in a postgraduate program in New Zealand, as the study focuses on the experiences and perspectives of respondents engaged in higher academic study. Similarly, the sample will not include unemployed persons who will be living in New Zealand at the time of data gathering and those who are currently in employment outside the country because they do not fall in the target population they are investigating. Finally, only those respondents who are willing to participate will be included. The exclusion parameters refocus the selection of the participants in a way that the most relevant individuals

to the research objectives and those that can offer the richest, relevant, applicable information are selected.

2.6.2 Sampling Frame

The sampling frame for this study will consist of selected postgraduate international students in New Zealand who are simultaneously enrolled in master's degree programs and employed on a part-time basis. While the overall population includes selected postgraduate students in the country, the sampling frame is limited to those that could be practically identified and reached by the researcher. This focused frame ensures the collection of robust and high-quality data by including individuals who share the same academic and employment affiliation. Furthermore, since purposive sampling is employed, the sampling frame ensures that all selected participants are not only accessible but also possess the qualifications to provide valuable information.

2.6.3 Sampling Technique

This study will employ the purposive sampling technique in particular, which is a non-probability sampling method commonly employed in its capacity to maximize collected data from a well-defined population (Campbell et al., 2020). In purposive sampling, the sample size is selected on the basis of predefined criteria, which are directly relevant to the research questions; thus, all selected respondents will contribute to answering those questions appropriately. The study population will include international graduates from New Zealand who are currently employed part-time. The specified group is of high relevance to the research, as they have firsthand experiences in transitioning from academic life into the foreign labor market and are knowledgeable in balancing these two spheres. They are simultaneously exposed to the workforce and the process of cultural integration and are thus in a good position to offer detailed insights into the interrelation between perceived organizational support and employment success. Moreover, due to direct exposure to workplace structure, supervisory relationships, and fair policy implementation, these respondents can provide sophisticated insights that are essential when analyzing employment-related variables such as appreciation of effort, managerial relations, working environment, and fairness at the workplace.

Purposive sampling is not chosen solely because of its methodological aptness but because it is a strategic design to represent the characteristics of a population where their attributes are pivotal to the research intentions (Bisht, 2024). The study will filter out the entire sample to include only the subjects that met the inclusion requirements, which will increase the depth and specificity of the data gathered. Finally, purposive sampling will ensure that the

findings will be more grounded in the veritable perspectives of the individuals best suited to inform the research findings, thereby making them more credible and applicable.

2.6.4 Sample Size

The sample size was determined to be 385 participants, calculated using the Calculator.net, and aims to seek representativeness and generalization to the target population. This population count will be enough to obtain significant data and yield reliable and valid findings. Sample size was sufficiently calculated to ensure statistical reliability and validity of the study. Calculator.net, a sample size calculator, was utilized to aid in the calculation of the final and actual sample size. The calculation of the minimum sample size was done using the 95 percent confidence interval and 5 percent margin of error, whereby the sample size was calculated as 385 respondents. This is a sufficiently high figure that will offer sufficient statistical power to confidently generalize the findings to the target group.

Formula:

$$n = \frac{Z^2 p(1-p)}{e^2}$$

- Z = z-value for desired confidence (1.96 at 95%)
- p = estimated proportion
- e = margin of error

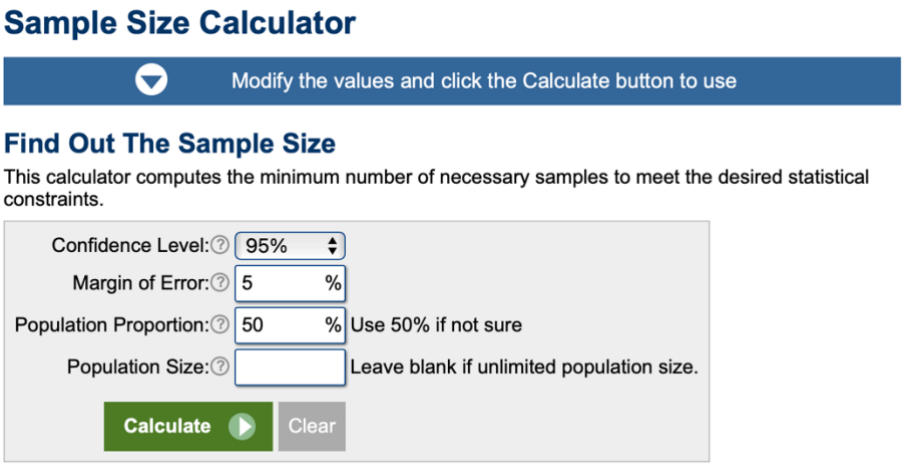

Figure 4: Screenshot grab to Calculator.net on 01/10/25

Using these values, the computation becomes accurate that a sample size of 385 participants is ideal between the septic point and the herculean point in terms of sample size precision and feasibility, and that the relationship between perceived organizational support and employment success among international postgraduate master's students in New Zealand can be accurately and confidently evaluated.

2.6.5 Data Collection

The data will be collected upon the formal approval of the concerned ethics review board. This is in order to ensure that the research procedures, tools, and methods are consistent with the established ethical principles and are appropriate to be adopted. To carry out the actual data collection, the researcher will undertake the actual data collection by making personal phone calls to the institutions and organizations where international students of postgraduate age groups and professional networking in New Zealand serve the international students in the country. At this stage, the logistical preparation of data collection will be done with finalizing the study location where it will be distributed in person and the creation of an online survey connection that will be secure to allow data collection remotely.

2.6.5.1 Administration of the Quantitative Correlational Research

The questionnaire will be sent both online and in person via QR code of the Google Forms survey based on the convenience and preference of the respondent. Before a participant answers the survey instrument, a standardized briefing will be done, which will include the purpose of the study, the scope of the inquiry, and the approximate duration of time needed to answer the survey instrument. Informed consent will be followed closely to make sure that the participation will be voluntary and confidential. The researcher will be available during the entire administration period to respond to any questions and provide advice to respondents when necessary and facilitate the questionnaire administration process as much as possible.

2.6.5.2 Management of Low Response Rates

A few strategies will be implemented to reduce the chances of low response rates. In a bid to make non-respondents respond, polite reminders will be sent to them at regular intervals during the data collection period via e-mail or through the messaging platforms widely used by Filipino student organizations. Second, the researcher will provide the relevance and the possible benefits of the participation that needs to be made (contribution to knowledge to enhance work outcomes among international students). Third, incentives, including minor tokens of gratitude or online certificates of participation, can be provided to motivate students to fill out the survey. These strategies will help to ensure that the sample size is maintained and that the findings will be representative of the target population.

2.6.5.3 Data Recording

After the data collection is done, all the responses will be collected and read through to ascertain completeness and accuracy. The responses that respondents will use in the paper-based questionnaire will be manually keyed into a secured database, and online questionnaire responses will be automatically downloaded into a password-protected system. The data sets will be analyzed thoroughly to identify missing, incomplete, or inconsistent information. Questionnaires with excessively missing data will either be followed up again to clarify the missing information or eliminated from the final data set depending on what is possible. Physical and electronic copies of these documents will be stored securely, and only the researcher will be capable of accessing these documents. This ensures that the data is maintained and confidentiality is maintained during the research.

2.6.6 Data Analysis

The data will be gathered, coded, and inputted into the Jamovi software to be organized and analyzed. In the process of answering the research questions, the researcher will engage in both descriptive and inferential statistics.

2.6.7 Frequency and Percentage

As Cooksey (2020) indicates, percentage frequency distribution is a way of presenting the data in a manner that indicates the percentage of observations that are available to each data point, or group of data points. It can be especially helpful when quantifying the relative frequency of survey answers as well as other categorical data and is frequently presented in tabular form, bar graphs, or pie charts. Presentation of the profile of the respondents will be done through this method.

Formula:

$$P = \frac{\sum f}{n} \times 100$$

Where:

P = Percentage

$\sum f$ = summation of frequency

n = total number of respondents

2.6.7.1 Weighted Mean.

Weighted Mean. A weighted mean is a form of average wherein certain data points carry more weight than others. When all the weights are equal, the mean is equivalent to the regular arithmetic mean. Weighted means are common when analyzing survey data, especially when assessing perceptions or rating evaluations (Ganti, 2024). in this case, it will be applied to evaluate respondents' assessments on the 1) Level of perceived organizational support experienced by international graduates in New Zealand in terms of recognition of employee contributions, supervisory support, quality of job conditions, and equitable workplace policies; and 2) Perceived level of employment success among international graduates in New Zealand in relation to both intrinsic and extrinsic outcomes.

Formula:

$$\bar{x} = \frac{\sum f}{n}$$

Where:

$\bar{x}$ = Mean

$\sum f$ = summation of frequency

n = total number of respondents

A 5-point rating scale was used to describe the computed means as follows:

Weighted Mean			Verbal Interpretation
1.00	-	1.49	Strongly Disagree
1.50	-	2.49	Disagree
2.50	-	3.49	Neutral
3.50	-	4.49	Agree
4.50	-	5.00	Strongly Agree

2.6.7.2 Analysis of Variance (ANOVA).

This statistical tool will be used to ascertain the presence of statistically significant variation between perceived organizational support and elements of employment success (intrinsic and extrinsic outcomes). ANOVA can be used when the means of three or more independent groups are compared to determine whether the observed differences are unlikely to have occurred by chance or whether the differences indicate real differences in the population.

Formula:

$$F = MST / MSE$$

MST = SST / (p - 1)

MSE = SSE / (N-p)

SSE = $\sum (n-1)s^2$

Where:

F = Anova Coefficient

MSB = Mean sum of squares between the groups

MSW = Mean sum of squares within the groups

MSE = Mean sum of squares due to error

SST = Total Sum of squares

p = Total number of populations

n = The total number of samples in a population

SSW = Sum of squares within the groups

SSB = Sum of squares between the groups

SSE = Sum of squares due to error

s = Standard deviation of the samples

N = Total number of observations

2.6.7.3 Pearson-r Correlation.

This statistical tool will be used to test whether there is a significant relationship between perceived organizational support and employment success among international graduates in New Zealand as perceived by the respondents.

Formula:

$$r = \frac{n\sum xy - (\sum x)(\sum y)}{\sqrt{[n\sum x^2 - (\sum x)^2][n\sum y^2 - (\sum y)^2]}}$$

Where: n – number of pair samples

x – mean score of competency-based functions

y – mean score of instructional leadership styles

r – correlation value

The numerical values will be interpreted based on the scale as follows:

Coefficient	Interpretation

± 1.00 - ± 0.70	Very Strong Relationship
± 0.69 – ±0.40	Strong Relationship
± 0.39 - ± 0.30	Moderate Relationship
± 0.29 - ± 0.20	Weak Relationship
± 0.19 – ± 0.01	Negligible Relationship